

PMSM Fault Diagnosis — Wavelet Scalogram + CNN

PMSM Fault Diagnosis using Wavelet Scalograms + CNN

«**University Name — Faculty**» · «**Department / Program**»

Students: **Mulham Fetna · Mohammad Zein Qabbani**

Supervisor: «**Dr. Supervisor Name**» · Academic year:
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*Research seminar — CNN classification of PMSM operating states
from time-frequency images*

1. The problem

- ▶ **PMSM** motors run EVs, robots, industrial servos, aircraft actuators.
- ▶ The most common stator fault — an **inter-turn short circuit** — can escalate to total winding failure within minutes.
- ▶ Goal: **detect faults automatically and early** from the motor's own signals.
- ▶ Classical methods (e.g. current spectrum analysis) need an expert to know *which* frequency to watch and break down when speed/load vary.

2. Our idea

Turn a **signal** problem into an **image** problem.

signal → segment → CWT → scalogram image → CNN → fault class
(current/ (Morlet) (224×224) Healthy / InterTu
vibration) (+ Demag / Overload)

- ▶ The CNN **learns** the fault signatures itself — no hand-designed features.
- ▶ Two signal channels studied: **stator current** and **vibration**.

3. System pipeline

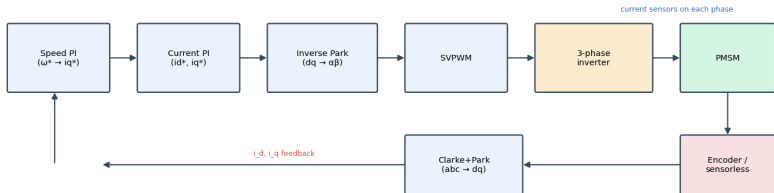
- ▶ **Sources:** real KAIST dataset (current + vibration), a synthetic generator, and MATLAB FOC/Simscape simulation.
- ▶ **One config + one manifest** drive everything (signal → scalogram → label → split): fully reproducible.
- ▶ Implemented in Python (TensorFlow/Keras, PyWavelets), MATLAB-free, **38 unit tests + CI**.

4. PMSM & its faults

- ▶ PMSM: permanent-magnet rotor locks onto the stator's rotating field → rotates **synchronously**, no slip → high efficiency.
- ▶ Driven by **Field-Oriented Control (FOC)** — current sensors are already present.
- ▶ Faults studied:
 - ▶ **Inter-turn short** (primary, real data)
 - ▶ **Demagnetization, Overload** (synthetic)

Motor & control system

Fig. Field-Oriented Control (FOC) of a PMSM



- ▶ Stator (3-phase winding) + PM rotor; driven by an **inverter** under **FOC**.
- ▶ The current loop **rejects disturbances** → **it masks the fault in the current**.
- ▶ That is *why vibration detects inter-turn faults far better* (our key result).

PMSM vs its relatives

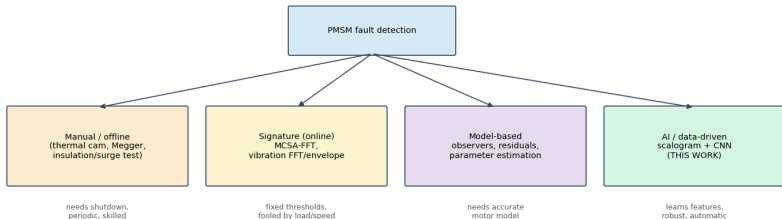
Fig. PMSM vs its relatives (PMDC / BLDC / Induction)

	PMSM	PMDC	BLDC	Induction
Commutation	Electronic (inverter)	Mechanical brushes	Electronic (inverter)	Electronic/DOL
Back-EMF	Sinusoidal	—(DC)	Trapezoidal	Sinusoidal
Efficiency	Very high	Medium	High	Medium
Torque density	Very high	Low	High	Medium
Control complexity	High (FOC)	Low	Medium	Medium/High
Maintenance	Low (no brushes)	High (brushes)	Low	Low
Rotor current	None	Yes (armature)	None	Induced (slip)
Typical use	EV, robotics, servo	Toys, simple drives	Drones, fans	Pumps, industry

- ▶ vs **PMDC**: same easy torque control, but no brushes → less maintenance.
- ▶ vs **BLDC**: sinusoidal back-EMF + FOC → smoother torque, higher efficiency.
- ▶ vs **Induction**: no rotor current/slip → higher efficiency & torque density.

Detecting the fault — today vs this work

Fig. Landscape of PMSM fault-detection methods



- ▶ Manual/offline (thermal, **Megger**, surge) → need shutdown, periodic.
- ▶ Online MCSA/vibration FFT → fixed thresholds, fooled by load/speed.
- ▶ **CWT scalogram + CNN** → learns features, robust, detects **earlier**.

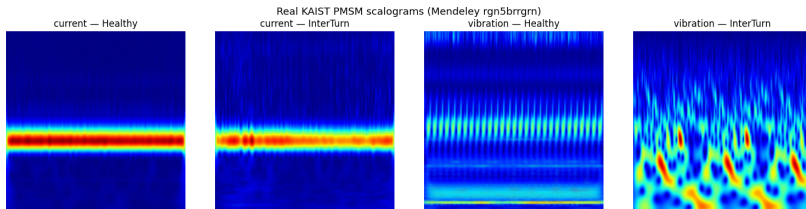
5. Why wavelets, not Fourier

- ▶ Fourier is **blind to time** — it can't say *when* a frequency occurs.
- ▶ Motor fault signals are **non-stationary** (transient, load-dependent).
- ▶ Uncertainty principle: $\Delta t \cdot \Delta f \geq \text{const}$ — can't have perfect time *and* frequency resolution.
- ▶ **Wavelets** = short, localised waves → frequency-dependent resolution, ideal for transients.

6. The CWT & scalogram

- ▶ Scale the **Morlet** wavelet (frequency knob) and slide it (time knob).
- ▶ Each coefficient = **similarity** of the signal to that wave at that time.
- ▶ **Scalogram** = colour image of energy vs. time (x) and frequency (y).
- ▶ Bright bands & side-bands = fault signatures the CNN can see.

7. Example scalograms (real KAIST data)



Inter-turn fault visibly **enriches the vibration time-frequency content.**

8. The dataset

- ▶ **KAIST PMSM stator-fault dataset** (Mendeley rgn5brrgrn, CC-BY-4.0).
- ▶ Current @ **100 kHz**, vibration @ **25.6 kHz** → decimated to 10 kHz.
- ▶ **3,150** scalogram segments (0.5 s windows, 50 % overlap).

Channel	Healthy	InterTurn
current	200 (4 rec.)	1350 (27 rec.)
vibration	200 (4 rec.)	1400 (28 rec.)

9. Leakage-free split

- ▶ Split by **recording**, not by segment → no correlated windows across train/test (no data leakage).
- ▶ Stratified by class, **per channel**, 70 / 15 / 15.
- ▶ Special care: only **4 healthy recordings** → force ≥ 1 into each split so every class is evaluable.

10. Class imbalance — the key issue

- ▶ Only **4 healthy** vs ~60 fault recordings.
- ▶ Naïve training → model predicts “faulty” for everything: **80 % “accuracy” but 0 % healthy detection.**
- ▶ Fix: **undersample the majority in train/val**, keep **test natural**.
- ▶ Report **balanced accuracy** & **macro-F1**, not raw accuracy.

11. CNN architecture

224×224×3

- Conv32 → Pool → Conv64 → Pool → Conv128 → Pool
- Flatten → Dropout(0.5) → Dense128 → Softmax

- ▶ Adam, sparse cross-entropy, early stopping, data augmentation.
- ▶ **Fusion** model: two branches (current + vibration) → global avg pool → concatenate → dense.

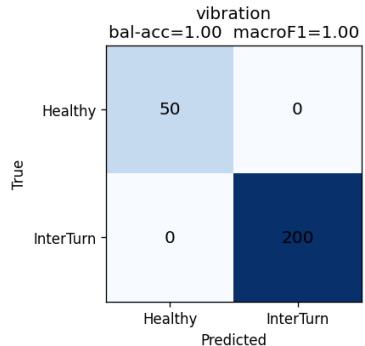
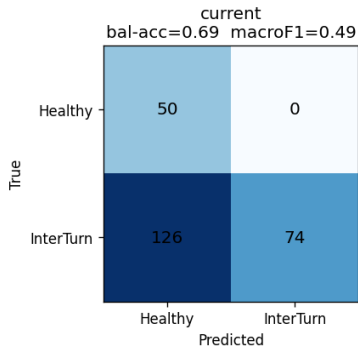
12. Results — real data

Channel	Balanced acc	Macro-F1	Healthy rec.	InterTurn re
Vibration	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
Fusion (cur.+vib.)	0.88	0.76	1.00	0.75
Current	0.69	0.49	1.00	0.37

Held-out recordings, Healthy vs Inter-turn.

13. Confusion matrices

Real KAIST PMSM — Healthy vs Inter-turn (held-out recordings)



Vibration is perfect; current misses most faults; fusion is in between.

14. Analysis

- ▶ **Vibration** $\gg$ **current** for inter-turn detection — physically expected (vibration responds directly; FOC suppresses current signatures).
- ▶ **Fusion** beats current but not vibration alone on this small data.
- ▶ Right **metric matters**: balanced accuracy exposed the majority-class collapse that raw accuracy hid.

15. Improvement experiments

- ▶ **Balancing** removes the majority-class collapse (current healthy recall 0.00 $\rightarrow$ 1.00).
- ▶ **Image size & training-set size** studied (see docs/experiments.md).
- ▶ Overfitting controlled by dropout, global average pooling, augmentation and early stopping.

16. Limitations

- ▶ Only **4 distinct healthy recordings** → perfect vibration score can't yet exclude a *recording-identity* shortcut.
- ▶ Demagnetization / Overload only synthetic.
- ▶ Fusion comparison indicative, not strictly controlled.

17. Conclusions & future work

- ▶ A reproducible scalogram + CNN pipeline detects inter-turn PMSM faults; **vibration reaches balanced accuracy 1.00** on held-out recordings.
- ▶ Future: more independent recordings; paired multi-channel fusion; severity-aware targets; explainability (Grad-CAM); on-line deployment in the drive.

Thank you

Questions?

Code, data instructions and full report:

`github.com/molhamfetnah/pmsm-fault-diagnosis-cnn-scalogram`